Acme Digital Solutions Private Limited
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Data Retention and Erasure Policy

Notice. CONFIDENTIAL TEMPLATE — This document contains sample organisational details for illustration only. Replace all references to Acme Digital Solutions Private Limited with your entity's particulars and obtain qualified legal review before execution or publication.

Field	Value
Document reference	ACME-POL-002
Document title	Data Retention and Erasure Policy
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Classification	Internal
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Next scheduled review	01 April 2027
Applicable law	DPDP Act, 2023 · DPDP Rules, 2025

1. Policy objective

This policy implements the storage limitation duty under Section 8(5) of the DPDP Act: personal data shall not be retained beyond the period necessary to satisfy the purpose for which it was collected. It applies to all business units of Acme Digital Solutions Private Limited.

2. Retention schedule

Record type	Business purpose	Retention period	Legal reference	Erasure method
Active customer account	Service delivery	Duration of relationship	DPDP S.8(5)	Account closure workflow
Closed customer account	Disputes, reactivation	3 years from closure	Limitation Act	DB purge + backup roll-off
KYC / KYB documents	RBI master directions	5 years from relationship end	RBI KYC Direction 2016	Secure wipe + shred
GST invoices & ledgers	Tax audit	8 years from FY end	CGST Act Sec. 36	Archive then delete
TDS / payroll records	Income tax	6 years from FY end	Income Tax Act Sec. 196	Encrypted archive
PF / ESI filings	Labour compliance	As per EPFO/ESIC rules	EPF Act	Statutory archive
Support tickets	Dispute resolution	24 months from closure	Internal	Freshdesk API delete
Marketing consent logs	Proof of consent	3 years from withdrawal	DPDP S.6	CRM purge
Application access logs	Security investigation	12 months minimum	DPDP Rule 8(3)	Log rotation
CCTV — office premises	Physical security	30 days rolling	Internal	Auto-overwrite
Job applications (rejected)	Recruitment	12 months from decision	Internal	ATS deletion

Record type	Business purpose	Retention period	Legal reference	Erasure method
Board / legal opinions	Corporate governance	Permanent (non-personal)	Companies Act	N/A
DPIA and RoPA records	Accountability	5 years from activity end	DPDP S.10	Compliance archive

3. Erasure procedure

Step 1: Trigger identified — retention period expiry, erasure request, consent withdrawal, or purpose fulfilment.

Step 2: Business owner confirms no legal hold, litigation or regulatory investigation prevents deletion.

Step 3: IT executes deletion from production systems; ticket logged in Jira project ACME-PRIV.

Step 4: Processors instructed to delete copies; confirmation received within 15 business days.

Step 5: Backups containing deleted data roll off within 30 days (90 days for disaster-recovery tapes).

Step 6: Grievance Officer confirms erasure to Data Principal where applicable.

4. Exceptions

Data may be retained beyond standard periods where necessary for: compliance with law; establishment, exercise or defence of legal claims; regulatory examination; or anonymised statistical analysis that cannot re-identify individuals. Extensions require written approval from Legal and the Data Protection Lead.

5. Roles and enforcement

Role	Responsibility
Data Protection Lead	Owns policy, quarterly retention review
System owners	Configure automated purge jobs
IT Operations	Execute technical deletion
Legal	Approve legal holds and extensions
HR	Employee data retention compliance

Document approval

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Prepared by	Compliance Team		
Reviewed by	Priya Sharma, Grievance Officer		
Approved by	Rahul Mehta, Chief Compliance Officer		